

Resume Version Comparison

Subodh Kulkarni, Ph.D. — Feb 17, 2026 vs. Mar 12, 2026

Evaluated against the Impact Bullet Builder™ framework

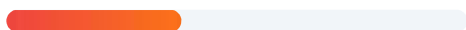


Score Comparison

FEB 17 VERSION (OLD)

38

/100



★ "You Did What Was Asked"

MAR 12 VERSION (NEW)

51

/100



★★ "You Went Above and Beyond"

Criteria	Feb 17	Mar 12	Change
Accomplishments (not duties)	5	7	+2
Metrics / Quantification	6	8	+2
How / Method	6	6	—
Why / Business Impact	3	5	+2
Personal Ownership	6	8	+2
Problem Context / "So What?"	3	4	+1
Action Verbs	6	8	+2
Bullet Quality Consistency	3	5	+2
OVERALL	38	51	+13

Verdict: The new version is meaningfully better — +13 points, and a full tier jump from ★ to ★★

The March 12 version made real, measurable improvements: the Summary went from generic claims to metric-driven statements, several bullets gained dollar-value business impact (\$30K, \$40K, \$85K, \$250K), weak bullets were removed, and personal ownership language is tighter. However, the new version also dropped some strong content (wire harness bullet, VB process innovation) that should be brought back. This isn't a case where you just reshuffled — you genuinely improved the resume. The remaining gap to ★★★ is about the issues identified in the full audit: splitting overloaded bullets, adding problem context, and translating internal acronyms.



What Got Better

9 improvements identified

1 Summary: Generic Claims → Metric-Driven

HIGH IMPACT

OLD — Feb 17

"Known for execution, flexibility, and agility to accomplish common goals and influencing without authority."

"Data driven decision maker with strong analytical skills and System Engineering Approach."

NEW — Mar 12

"Drove 70–90% repeat defect reductions across multiple John Deere combine programs, delivered \$125K+ in documented annual cost savings at Pella, and secured \$500K+ in research grants."

Why this matters: The old summary could have been written by any engineer. The new one leads with specific, quantified results that are uniquely yours. A recruiter reading the first 2 lines now immediately knows the scale and impact of your career. This is the single biggest improvement on the resume.

2 Added Dollar Impact to 4 Bullets

HIGH IMPACT

Bullet	Old \$	New \$
Meeting consolidation (FGR/DPAR)	None	\$30,000/yr
Frame rework reduction	"30 hrs/wk"	\$40,000 build
Warranty issues (OFP)	None	\$85,000/yr
J.B. Hunt logistics	None	\$250,000

Why this matters: Adding dollar values is the single most effective way to move a bullet from ★★ to ★★★. The old resume had percentage reductions but rarely connected them to business outcomes. The new version now shows \$405K+ in quantified impact across these 4 bullets.

3 Removed 3 Weak Bullets

REMOVED ✓

"Successfully executed a special quality assurance project for 135 PMGNs."

Good cut — vague, no outcome, no metric beyond a count.

REMOVED ✓

"Helped identifying and escalated program risks with quantified impact on a sensor support failures..."

Good cut — "Helped identifying" is weak language with a grammatical error. Vague outcome.

REMOVED ✓

"Revised HX work instructions for non-conforming material processes and timelines, standardizing quality response across the factory."

Good cut — duty-level process description with no quantified outcome.

Why this matters: Cutting weak bullets raises your average. A resume with 15 bullets averaging ★★ reads much stronger than one with 20 bullets where 5 are ★ level — the weak ones drag the reader's perception of the whole document down.

4 CAR Reduction Bullet: Added Before/After Numbers

OLD

"Reduced repeat defects (CARs) by 70% year-over-year on the MY26 program..."

NEW

*"Reduced repeat defects (CARs) by 70% year-over-year **from 83 to 16** on the MY26 program..."*

Why this matters: "70% reduction" is strong. "From 83 to 16" is even stronger — it gives the reader a concrete before-and-after that's harder to dismiss or question. Specific numbers build trust.

5

Frame Rework Bullet: Added DTAC Solution + Prevented Returns

OLD

"...Piloted automated data collection for quality parameters on the same Caribou Frames."

NEW

*"...developed DTAC solution that **prevented around 100 frames** returning to factory."*

Why this matters: "Piloted automated data collection" is interesting but vague. "Prevented 100 frames from returning to factory" is a clear business outcome with a number attached. This tells the reader you solved a real problem for the field, not just collected data.

6

J.B. Hunt Bullet: Added \$250K Impact

OLD

"Delivered 4 SQL-based back-end cost update projects used by senior leadership for strategic logistical decision-making across the transportation network."

NEW

*"Delivered SQL-based back-end cost update project for intermodal logistical decisions with **estimated savings of \$250,000** to avoid empty containers hauling back to departure depot."*

Why this matters: The old version told us what you built and who used it. The new version tells us the financial impact. \$250K in savings is a headline number. (The old version's "4 projects" specificity was lost — ideally you'd combine both: "4 SQL-based projects... \$250K in estimated savings.")

7

Community Service: Added \$30K Donation Impact

OLD

"Board of Directors, STEAM ON WHEELS - a nonprofit dedicated to youth STEAM development."

NEW

*"Raised and donated approximately **\$30,000** to various non-profit organizations via sale of handcrafted wooden cultural artifacts..."*

Why this matters: A board title is a position. \$30K raised through personal effort is an accomplishment. The new version also shows creativity and initiative — handcrafting cultural artifacts is a memorable differentiator.

8 John Deere R&D Section: 10 Bullets → 5 (Tighter Focus)

The old version had 10 bullets for the R&D role, including several that were overlapping or ★-level. The new version consolidated to 5 focused bullets, each with a clear metric. This makes the section easier to scan and raises the average quality per bullet.

9 Sensor Bullet: Added Timeline + Meeting Count

"Over 4 years" and "23 sensor application review meetings" were added, giving the reader a sense of the sustained effort and methodical approach behind the 90% reduction. These details strengthen the "How" component.



What Got Worse or Lost

6 items to address

1

Lost: Wire Harness Bullet (Strong Content Dropped)

SIGNIFICANT

WAS IN FEB 17 — NOW GONE

"Reduced pre-production wire harness failures across 80+ machines by collaborating with suppliers and design engineers to identify and correct defects in intermittently functioning Ethernet cable, FLP harnesses, and transmission harnesses before machines left the factory. Resolved 200+ NCCAs and ~500 field events; reduced repeat issues by 50% over the years."

This should come back. 80+ machines, 200+ NCCAs, 500 field events, 50% reduction — this bullet has strong scale metrics and shows supplier collaboration. It would need the same treatment (split, add dollar impact, reduce jargon), but the raw content is too strong to cut. Consider making this its own bullet focused on the 50% reduction across 80+ machines, with an estimated \$ value for prevented pre-production failures.

2

Lost: "First-Ever" Verification Build Process

SIGNIFICANT

WAS IN FEB 17 — NOW GONE

"Established the first-ever Verification Build (VB) process for wire harness programs, proactively segregating 10 current-product issues from PDP issues and influencing cross-functional teams without direct authority to remediate them before production builds."

This should come back. "First-ever" is one of the most powerful phrases you can put on a resume — it signals innovation and initiative, not just execution. This bullet shows you created something that didn't exist before. It needs dollar impact and clearer language, but the story — building a new process from scratch and influencing without authority — is exactly the kind of leadership narrative senior roles look for.

3 Lost: 20%+ Customer Productivity Improvement Claim

WAS IN FEB 17 — NOW GONE

"...automation contributed to an estimated 20%+ improvement in customer productivity through newly launched features."

Consider adding back if defensible. This was the one "Why" statement in the old CAR reduction bullet that connected your work to customer outcomes. If you can back this up with data or a reasonable estimate, it should be on the resume — it's the kind of end-user impact statement that separates a quality engineer from a quality *leader*.

4 Lost: Specific Warranty Issue Examples

The Feb 17 OFP bullet named specific issues: *"ladder damage reduction, auger engagement improvements, hydraulic valve leak elimination, and rear axle motor spindle failure prevention."* The Mar 12 version only kept "ladder damage." The specific issue names make the bullet more credible and technically concrete — consider adding back 2–3 of the most impressive examples.

5 Lost: MY26 Feature Scope (8 Customer-Facing Features)

The Feb 17 version had: *"Led end-to-end quality delivery for the MY26 Large Combine program across 8 customer-facing features (embedded 32-bit software, Combine Auto Unload, Smart Data Capture Controller, and 5 others)."* While the bullet itself was duty-level, the scope context — 8 features with specific names — is valuable and could be integrated into the existing CAR reduction bullet to show the breadth of what you managed.

6 New Typo: "supplies" → should be "suppliers"

In the Quality Engineer (OFP) bullet: *"driving corrective actions across **supplies** and cross-functional stakeholders"* — should be **"suppliers."** The old version had this correct. Small issue but easy to fix.



Section-by-Section Breakdown

Section	Old #	New #	Verdict	Key Change
Summary	3	4	Better	Generic claims → metric-driven statements with \$125K, 70–90%, \$500K
John Deere R&D	10	5	Mixed	Cut weak bullets and added \$ values (good), but lost wire harness + VB process bullets (not good)
Module Leader	2	2	Better	Added real-time matching specificity to staffing model
Quality Engineer OFP	2	1	Better	Removed duty bullet, added \$85K warranty cost — but lost specific issue names and introduced typo
J.B. Hunt	1	1	Better	Added \$250K savings — lost "4 projects" specificity
Pella	2	2	Same	Unchanged
Farm Machinery	3	3	Same	Unchanged
Earlier Roles	4	4	Same	Unchanged (Research Asst, Deputy Chief Engineer, Elpro)
Skills / Certs	—	—	Same	Identical
Community Service	3	3	Better	Replaced board title with \$30K donation + personal effort story



Untouched Sections — Still Need Work

These sections were identical in both versions. Each has opportunities identified in the full audit:

Pella (2 bullets)

Already strong at ★★ level. The painting reduction bullet (\$125K/year) is one of the best on the resume. The scuff reduction bullet would benefit from a dollar value — 10% reduction in rejections for what \$ amount?

Farm Machinery Specialist (3 bullets)

Grant + publication bullets are solid. The third bullet (training programs) is still a duty description with no outcome metrics — how many programs, how many people trained, what was the measurable result?

Sr. Research Assistant (1 bullet)

Still reads as a completion statement ("Completed 3 projects... within time"). Needs to be rewritten with research outcomes, not completion status.

Deputy Chief Engineer (2 bullets)

The nuclear power plant bullet is strong (★★★ level — scale, complexity, bonus outcome). The sugarcane harvester bullet needs an impact statement beyond prototype count.

Production Engineer (1 bullet)

3% efficiency gain from 30 years ago — consider removing this role entirely or condensing to a single line to free space for stronger content.

Technical Skills

Identical in both versions. Several tools (ANSYS, SolidWorks, Pro/E, ArcGIS, ENVI, ERDAS IMAGINE) still don't appear in any bullet. They'd be stronger shown in context.



Next Steps to Reach ★★★

1 Bring back the wire harness and VB process bullets — with improvements

These were strong content that was lost in the consolidation. Add them back with dollar impact and clearer language. The wire harness bullet (80+ machines, 50% reduction) and the "first-ever" VB process are differentiators that should be on the resume.

2 Add the "Why" to the 70% CAR and 90% sensor bullets

These are your two strongest percentage reductions and neither has a dollar value or business outcome attached yet. Even a conservative estimate of warranty costs prevented or production hours saved would push these to ★★★.

3 Replace Summary bullet 4 with a quantified result

"Partnered with suppliers... to ship on time" describes your approach, not a result. The first 3 summary bullets are excellent — the 4th should match their standard with a specific number.

4 Translate internal acronyms for outside readers

EPDP, FGR, DPAR, LPB, DTAC, CARs — these all mean something to you, but a hiring manager at another company will skim right past them. Spell them out or describe the process in plain language.

5 Fix the typo and add back specific warranty issue names

"Supplies" → "suppliers" in the OFP bullet. And consider adding back "auger engagement, hydraulic valve leak, rear axle motor spindle" — these specific technical details add credibility.

Bottom Line

The March 12 version is genuinely better than the February 17 version — this isn't a lateral move. You jumped a full tier (★ → ★★), added \$405K+ in quantified business impact across 4 bullets, eliminated weak content, and transformed the summary from generic to compelling. The path from 51 to 70+ is about bringing back the strong content that was cut (wire harness, VB process), adding dollar impact to the percentage-only bullets, and making the resume readable for anyone outside John Deere. You're closer to ★★★ than you might think — most of the raw material is already there.

